



Sad demise

Aaron Swartz, American computer programmer, co-author of the RSS 1.0 specification, and internet activist was found dead on 11th January



Intel update

Due to the decline in desktop PC sales, Intel has decided to discontinue manufacturing desktop motherboards within the next three years

CES TOP 20

Here's a look at the hottest gadgets from the world's biggest electronics show

CES 2013 brought with it a lot of announcements, and while we can't say the world has effectively changed overnight, several paradigm shifts are more readily apparent. And we did see trends that we expect will make their way into homes and pervade general society by the end of the year.

A variety of new technologies were shown off at CES. From a flourish of 4K televisions and other forms of high-resolutions displays, to new ranges of mobile and tablet processors from all the big names. We even saw new Android and PC gaming devices, as well as a few innovations in storage, touch and virtual reality technologies.

4K TVs – In first place, simply by the number of major manufacturers showcasing a multitude of wares at CES, were 4K TVs (Ultra HD). They came in all shapes and sizes, curved and flat; all types – LCDs, LEDs,



OLEDs, AMOLEDs, and were made by every name in the business of displays – LG, Panasonic, Samsung, Sharp, Sony,

Toshiba, and even ViewSonic. The first devices are expected to launch later this year, around the American summer.

Razer Edge gaming tablet

While it was not the online portable gaming device of this year's CES, the Razer Edge certainly attracted a lot of eyeballs, being the perfect example of a mobile device touted to have the power of a full fledged PC desktop. Due in February, with a \$999 price



tag, the Razer Edge will ship with Windows 8, a 3rd Gen Intel Core i5 or i7 CPU, a discrete GeForce GT 640M GPU, an SSD (up to 256GB), and a 10.1-inch IPS display with a 1,366x768-pixel native resolution. A bunch of controller accessories will also be available.

Samsung Exynos 5 Octa

Samsung took the wraps off an 8-core processor, the Exynos 5 Octa. It will apparently offer a "level of pure processing power never before seen in a mobile device," enabling heavy-duty multi-tasking without lag or disruption. It is also built to easily handle HD movie

streaming with no dropped frames and razor-sharp picture quality. Designed for high-end smartphones and tablets, it uses ARM's big.LITTLE technology, pairing four ARM Cortex-A7 chips with four Cortex A15 multicore chips. First expected in the S IV and Note II, more details are due at MWC.

Oculus Rift – A virtual reality headset, the Oculus Rift from Oculus VR is a giant visor that straps to your head. The prototype development version shown off at CES 2013 was built of moulded plastic. It is then connected to the Oculus Rift Box, that is connected to an Xbox 360 or similar console via HDMI or DVI, and controlled via controller and head tracking. Currently at 720p HD resolution, exact specs have not been decided yet. Early impressions of the device have been very positive, and we hope to see consumer-ready versions ready sometime in the near future.



Tactus Pop-up Touch Tech – Tactus uses microfluid technology to raise buttons out of

a touchscreen. On the demo Android-based unit, when the OS called for a keyboard, the buttons raise out of the screen almost instantly, offering a small amount of resistance, enough to survive an accidental touch. When Android no longer needs the keyboard, the buttons instantly melt back. CEO and founder, Craig Ciesla states that the touch buttons can be configured into any design, including gamepad configurations. The



technology is expected to make its way to major manufacturer's devices by the end of the year.

Valve Steam Box – While Valve didn't actually showcase its Steam Box console, founder Gabe Newell did outline what the product would be like in an interview with The Verge. With its own version expected only in 2014, multiple partners will be able to offer Steam Boxes in the meanwhile. At CES 2013, Xi3 showed off the Piston Steam Box prototype, replete with a very large number of ports. The Valve Steam Box will apparently also be able to act like a server, with